

<https://www.espressoenglish.net/100-idioms-meanings-examples/>

Match the Idiom with Its Meaning

Write the correct number (1–17) in each blank.

Idioms:

- | | |
|--------------------------------------|---|
| 1. A blessing in disguise | () To reconcile or make peace after a conflict. |
| 2. A dime a dozen | () Feeling nervous or hesitant about doing something. |
| 3. All ears | () To confront the consequences of one's actions. |
| 4. All in the same boat | () Avoiding the main topic or being indirect. |
| 5. Barking up the wrong tree | () Something that seems bad or unlucky at first but turns out to be good. |
| 6. Beat around the bush | () Just barely or narrowly escaping a difficult situation. |
| 7. Bite the bullet | () Accusing or blaming the wrong person. |
| 8. Bury the hatchet | () Experience the same negative treatment you have given to others. |
| 9. By the skin of your teeth | () To stop working or to end an activity. |
| 10. Call it a day | () Very common and easy to find. |
| 11. Cold feet | () In the same situation or predicament. |
| 12. Cry over spilled milk | () Something positive in a difficult situation. |
| 13. Cut corners | () To face a difficult or unpleasant situation bravely. |
| 14. Drive someone up the wall | () To worry or complain about something that has already happened and cannot be changed. |
| 15. Silver lining | () To do something quickly or take shortcuts, often sacrificing quality. |
| 16. Face the music | () Fully listening and paying attention. |
| 17. Get a taste of your own medicine | () To irritate or annoy someone greatly. |

TEXT 1 – Conversation: *Coffee Shop Talk*

Characters:

- **Liam** – tired, just finished work
- **Maya** – his friend, relaxed and sarcastic
- **Tom** – their coworker, always complaining

1. face the music
2. bite the bullet
3. drive someone up the wall
4. all in the same boat
5. cut corners

Maya: Hey, you look exhausted. Long day?

Liam: You have no idea. My boss made me redo the entire report because I “used the wrong font.” I swear, he’s trying to **(1)** _____ me.

Maya: (laughing) Oh, classic Mr. Greene. He’s been like that since forever. You should’ve seen him last week—he asked me to print thirty copies of a 200-page file because “the system might crash.”

Tom: Wait, wait. Are we seriously still talking about Greene? Come on, we’re **(2)** _____ here. We all suffer together.

Maya: True. But at least it’s Friday. I’m calling it a day after this coffee.

Liam: Lucky you. I still have to finish an online presentation tonight. I might just **(3)** _____ and get it done instead of dragging it till Sunday.

Tom: That’s the spirit! Oh, and speaking of work, did you hear that James got cold feet before his interview with the London branch?

Maya: No way! He was so confident!

Tom: Yeah, apparently the idea of moving abroad freaked him out. I guess it’s better than moving there and realizing it was a mistake, right?

Liam: Maybe. But knowing James, he’ll cry over spilled milk for weeks.

Maya: (smiling) That’s him. Anyway, I’m starving. Should we grab a pizza?

Tom: Yes! But not that cheap place you chose last time. They totally **(4)** _____ — half the toppings were missing.

Liam: Ha! True. Never again.

Maya: Okay, okay, fine. But this time you’re paying, since you owe me from last week.

Tom: Yeah, yeah. Let me check my wallet first. Oh, great. I forgot my card.

Liam: (rolling his eyes) Guess what? You're gonna have to **(5)**_____, Tom.

Tom: Alright, alright! I'll pay next time. You guys never let me off the hook!

IDIOMS DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. Have you ever experienced **a blessing in disguise** — something bad that turned out to be good? What happened?
2. Can you think of something in your city that's **a dime a dozen**?
3. When someone tells you an important story, do you usually stay **all ears** or get distracted easily?
4. Describe a moment when you and your friends were **all in the same boat**.
5. Have you ever **barked up the wrong tree** by blaming the wrong person?
6. Do you know someone who always **beats around the bush** instead of being direct?
7. When was the last time you had to **bite the bullet** and do something really hard?
8. How do you usually **bury the hatchet** after a fight with someone?
9. Tell me about a time you succeeded **by the skin of your teeth** — almost failed, but made it!
10. When do you usually decide to **call it a day** at work or study?
11. Have you ever got **cold feet** before doing something big or scary?
12. What's something you regret but know there's no point in **crying over spilled milk**?
13. Why do some people **cut corners** when doing projects or jobs?
14. Who in your life can **drive you up the wall** sometimes?
15. Can you think of a difficult situation that had a **silver lining** in the end?

Freelance listening: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7vtlMRV1sxY>

Freelancing work: <https://www.upwork.com/resources/what-is-freelancing>

1. In your field, what skills are **a dime a dozen**, and which ones make you stand out?
2. When discussing a new project with a client, do you usually stay **all ears** or do you prefer reading instructions later?
3. Do you think freelancers are **all in the same boat** when it comes to unstable income? Why or why not?
4. Why do you think some companies **beat around the bush** when giving feedback to employees?
5. Tell me about a time you had to **bite the bullet** and take a job outside your comfort zone.
6. Have you ever had to **bury the hatchet** with a coworker or client to keep the partnership alive?
7. Have you ever completed a project **by the skin of your teeth**, just before the deadline?
8. When working remotely, how do you know when it's time to **call it a day**?
9. Did you ever get **cold feet** before starting your first project?
10. Is there anything you wish you'd done differently early in your career, or is it just **crying over spilled milk** now?
11. In your opinion, what are the risks of trying to **cut corners** when working with clients?
12. What habits from clients or teammates **drive you up the wall** when working remotely?
13. When starting a new job, what would be a potential **silver lining** in facing challenges?
14. Have you ever had to **face the music** after making a mistake at work?
15. Can you think of a time when a difficult client/colleague finally **got a taste of their own medicine**?
16. Have you ever taken a low-pay project because it seemed like **a blessing in disguise** later on?
17. When working with many freelancers, do you feel you're **all in the same boat** when it comes to competition?
18. Why do you think rookies sometimes **beat around the bush** when asking for fair payment?

1. Get the ball rolling
2. Give someone the benefit of the doubt
3. Go the extra mile
4. Hit the nail on the head
5. Keep your chin up
6. Kill two birds with one stone
7. Let the cat out of the bag
8. Make a long story short
9. Not my cup of tea
10. On cloud nine

- A. To reveal a secret or confidential information.
- B. To identify or describe something accurately.
- C. To start a process or activity.
- D. Feeling extremely happy or joyful.
- E. To believe someone's statement or excuse without being too suspicious.
- F. Something that is not to your liking or preference.
- G. To put in extra effort or do more than what is expected.
- H. To give a brief summary or conclusion.
- I. To remain positive and optimistic during difficult times.
- J. Accomplish two things at the same time with a single action.

IDIOMS DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. Describe a situation in your life when you had to **get the ball rolling** but felt unsure about how things would turn out. What happened after you took the first step?
2. Tell me about a time when you decided to **give someone the benefit of the doubt**. Looking back, do you think it was the right decision?
3. Have you ever **gone the extra mile** for someone at work, in your studies, or in your personal life? What motivated you to do that?

4. Think of a moment when someone **hit the nail on the head** while describing a problem or a situation. Why was their comment so accurate?
5. When life gets challenging, what helps you **keep your chin up**? Can you share an example of a difficult period and how you stayed positive?
6. Describe a time when you managed to **kill two birds with one stone**. What did you accomplish, and why was it efficient?
7. Have you ever accidentally **let the cat out of the bag**? What was the secret, and how did people react?
8. Tell me about a situation where you decided to **make a long story short**. Why did you feel the need to summarize instead of giving all the details?
9. Is there something that most people enjoy but is **not your cup of tea**? Explain why it doesn't appeal to you, even though it's popular.
10. Describe a moment when you were **on cloud nine**. What caused that feeling, and how long did it last?